From Windfall to Whiplash: Five Vaccine Makers, 2015–2025

COVID vaccine purchases drove a 2021–22 boom. Diversified drugmakers kept growing after it; mRNA makers fell back. Kindergarten MMR coverage was already slipping.

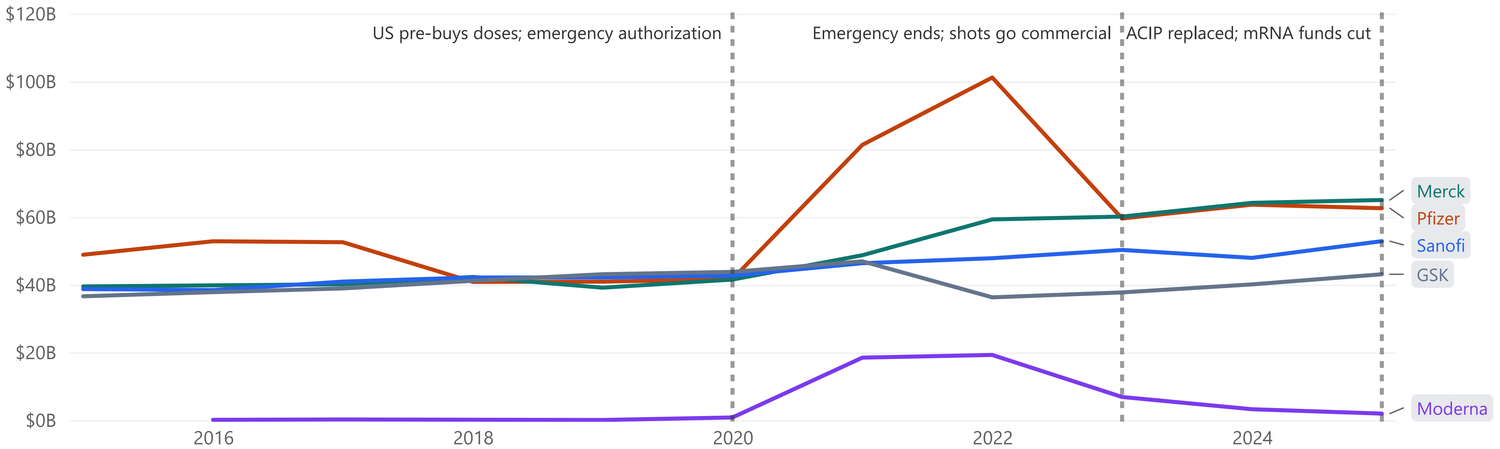
Moderna revenue, 2025 vs. 2022 peak
-90%
$19.3B (2022) → $1.9B (2025)

Pfizer revenue, 2025 vs. 2022 peak
-38%
$101.2B (2022) → $62.6B (2025)

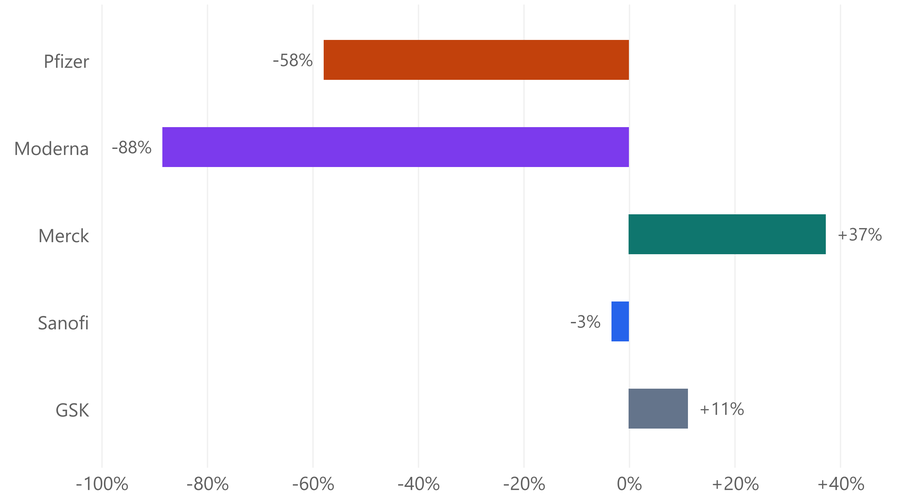
Merck + Sanofi + GSK revenue, 2019 to 2025
+29%
$124.4B (2019) → $160.9B (2025)

Kindergarten vaccine exemptions, 2019–20 to 2025–26
2.5% → 4.2%
Share of kindergartners with any exemption

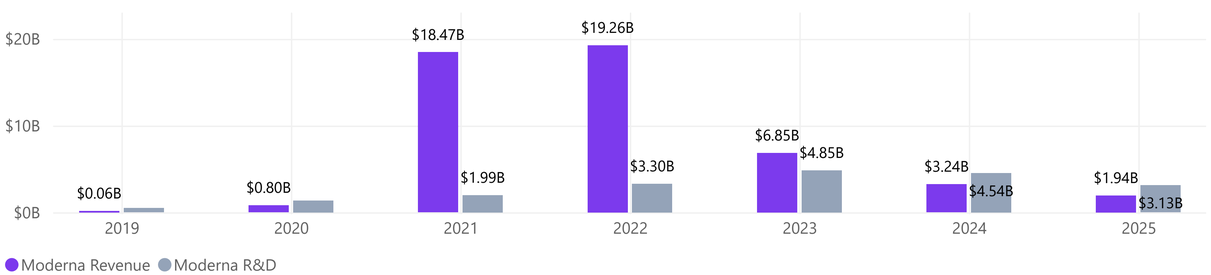
Revenue ($B): COVID vaccines created a 2021–22 spike at Pfizer and Moderna; diversified peers kept growing



Share price change, end of 2021 to end of 2025

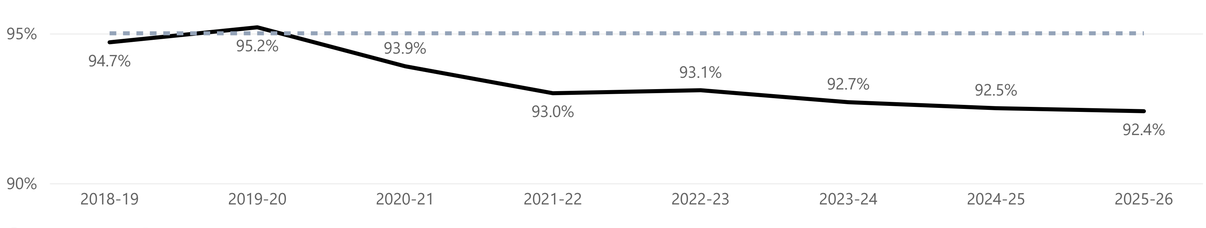


Moderna ($B): R&D spending now exceeds sales, $1.61 per $1 of revenue in 2025



Kindergartners with both MMR doses: 95.2% in 2019–20, 92.4% in 2025–26 (95% target dashed)

Note: 2020–21 school-year data collection was disrupted by COVID-19 (CDC); y-axis starts at 90%.



Sources: Company 10-K / annual report figures (Muhlenberg Data Lab contest dataset); CDC MMWR kindergarten vaccination reports and SchoolVaxView; CIDRAP Vaccine Integrity Project federal vaccine timeline; HHS via AHCJ (BARDA mRNA cuts, Aug 2025); U.S. DoD and FDAnews (Operation Warp Speed).

Notes: Moderna IPO Dec 2018 (no earlier share price or 2015 financials). GSK 2022 revenue drop reflects the Haleon spin-off. Merck 2023 R&D includes acquisition charges. Sanofi/GSK converted from EUR/GBP. Year-end share prices, excluding dividends. Policy markers show timing, not cause. Coverage axis starts at 90%.